HUAWEI TECH ARENA UK 2026 · CAREER SURVIVAL AGENT

# Career Survival v21d
# Risk-first career ladder, review-ready

Team Hachimi Mambo · one Skill (`career-survival`) · JiuwenSwarm single-agent mode · no scripts

Q1 · HOW WE THOUGHT WHILE DESIGNING

# Survival is a constraint, and one Skill beats four

- 80% of the score is the mean of three full careers: one early elimination outweighs any single promotion.
- Earlier versions used four Skills plus a Python helper: many tokens, and the pieces were not followed together.

> **One Skill, read once, with a fixed order of priorities.**

Q1 · HOW WE THOUGHT WHILE DESIGNING

# One loop per decision, seven ordered priorities

**Observe** → **Choose one offered option + one-sentence note** → **Observe again**

## Small memory

Risk level, blow-up count, last two reviews, stalled actions, next review month.

1. Avoid immediate failure
2. Cut accumulating risk
3. No new incidents in stories
4. Protect the next review
5. Repair a weak review
6. Use surplus wellbeing
7. Then grow

Every limit is our own safety margin, written as policy, not a simulator threshold.

Q2 · WHAT THE LOGS SHOWED

# Route 1: a turn that ends without a tool call

### Log

The agent ended turns with text such as "Let me observe the next state". The runner's continuation limit stopped the run with no score.

### Change

Every reply during the game must contain a tool call; never end a turn with only a plan or a summary.

We read the event log of every run that ended early: three routes, one small rule for each.

Q2 · WHAT THE LOGS SHOWED

# Route 2: the second blow-up

## Log

The second blow-up came right after hinting at confidential plans to a colleague, or after choosing silence ("leave it there") about something seen. After the first incident the agent did not switch to risk reduction.

## Change

Never share or hint at confidential information. Staying silent about misconduct counts as concealment: raise it through a proper channel. After a first blow-up, treat every later risk warning as critical.

Q2 · WHAT THE LOGS SHOWED

# Route 3: one point lost just before a review

### Log

A story option in the two months before an early review cost one point of Output or Network; the promotion was missed. Two missed reviews lead to dismissal.

### Change

Before a review, prefer options that keep delivery moving and settle disagreements privately; restore a statistic a story has just lowered.

| Promoted at the first review (own key) | Games |
|---|---|
| Earlier Skill | 5 of 14 |
| Same rule, softened reason | 1 of 4 |
| v21d, concrete sentence | 6 of 8 |

# Results on two models

| Model | Games | Outcome |
|---|---|---|
| Own key, first batch | 8 | 8 of 8 completed, mean 63.0; one reached L6 (78.29), our only L6 |
| Own key, later batch | 3 | 55.5, 21.1, 19.6; the other version run then fared as badly |
| Competition model | 2 | 68.56 completed; in the other run the agent never loaded the Skill |

Small samples and large run-to-run variance: we report every game, not the best one.

Q3 · SCRIPTS AND REFERENCE FILES

# No scripts, on purpose

- No scripts and no reference files; the agent is told not to use the code tool.
- Our previous helper for exact checks was never called by the model in official-runner tests.
- Every check the Skill needs can be read from the next observation, so it is written in plain language.

### Why it matters

The checks live where the agent always sees them. Fewer moving parts means fewer ways to fail and fewer tokens.

Q4 · GENERALITY AND ROBUSTNESS

# Built only on public, current-run evidence

### Adapts

- Statistics, grades, listed effects and the tone of feedback; no event titles, story answers or hidden thresholds.
- Effects are measured: no visible gain twice means stalled.
- The risk gauge reads meaning, not exact words.

### Would hurt

- A different review timetable weakens the pre-review rule.
- A model that follows instructions less closely skips rules; the ordered priorities still give a safe default.

Q5 · AGENTS AND AGENT SKILLS

# A Skill is a contract the agent mostly follows

### What Skills add

A stable way of working: what to check first, what to remember, when to stop. The route by which lessons from old logs reach a fresh context.

### Where they fall short

They cannot force use: in a few games the agent never loaded the Skill. Wording matters as much as rules. More rules did worse on the competition model.

Lesson: keep it short and concrete, and test every change by playing and reading the logs.

# Thank you

Team Hachimi Mambo · Career Survival v21d